

Intelligence Report

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Executive Summary

Sree Vaikundeswara Devasthanam, an Idukki-based temple has been involved in a gold misappropriation case where gold-clad ceremonial items were downgraded in records and sent to Chennai for gold extraction. The items were later routed through accounts held by a Bengaluru intermediary, M. Naveen Pillai. P. Sundaram, a Chennai-based jeweler is under investigation as he is connected with the receiving and melting of these ceremonial gold items.

Key Findings

- Sree Vaikundeswara Devasthanam has been involved in a gold misappropriation case where gold-clad ceremonial items were downgraded in records and sent to Chennai for extraction.
- Chennai-based jeweler P. Sundaram is connected to the receiving and melting of these ceremonial gold items through his Sowcarpet facility.
- Payments related to this operation were routed through six bank accounts across three states.

Recommendations

- Conduct a thorough investigation into temple officials involved, including K. Ramachandran, for potential misuse of authority.
- Trace the origin and extraction process of gold items at Chennai-based Sowcarpet area facilities.
- Analyze transactions routed through M. Naveen Pillai's accounts in Bengaluru to uncover money laundering activities.

Source Citations

- <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/kerala/temple-gold-ed-investigation-2026>
- <https://reddit.com/r/IndianTemples/comments/jkl567>
- <https://www.manoramaonline.com/news/kerala/idukki-temple-gold-discrepancy-2026>
- <https://reddit.com/r/Kerala/comments/pqr234>
- <https://reddit.com/r/IndianFinance/comments/stu567>
- https://t.me/temple_watch_kerala/456
- <https://rti.kerala.gov.in/response/KL-IDK-2026-1847>
- <https://rti.kerala.gov.in/response/KL-IDK-2026-1903>
- <https://rti.kerala.gov.in/response/KL-IDK-2026-2011>